Nordheim Online



ProtoGNOME

Installation and User Guide

Version 1.0.14 · **Platforms** Linux (GNOME) · **Updated** October 2026

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Contents

1 About ProtoGNOME

2 Supported tools and launchers

3 System requirements

4 Installing ProtoGNOME

5 Quick start

6 Using ProtoGNOME

7 How installs are protected

8 GitHub token (optional)

9 Privacy and files

10 Troubleshooting

11 Support and license

1 About ProtoGNOME

ProtoGNOME installs and removes compatibility tools for Linux gaming, such as **GE-Proton**, for Steam and the Heroic Games Launcher. It also shows which compatibility tool each of your Steam games uses. It's a GNOME-friendly app with no KDE or Qt dependencies.

ProtoGNOME is a community fork of **ProtonUp-Qt** by DavidoTek, rebuilt with Flutter. It is not affiliated with Valve, Steam, ProtonUp-Qt or the authors of the tools it installs.

What ProtoGNOME does

- Lists recent releases of two compatibility tools, GE-Proton and Luxtorpeda, straight from their GitHub projects.
- Downloads and installs a release into Steam or Heroic with one click, and removes it again.
- Verifies every download before installing it, and refuses anything it can't verify.
- Shows your Steam games and the compatibility tool assigned to each (read-only).

ProtoGNOME is free, open-source software under the GNU General Public License v3. Source: github.com/TaliskerMan/ProtoGNOME.

2 Supported tools and launchers

Tool	Source project	What it's for
GE-Proton	GloriousEggroll/proton-ge-custom	Proton with extra fixes and codecs
Luxtorpeda	luxtorpeda-dev/luxtorpeda	Runs some games on native Linux engines

ProtoGNOME offers only tools whose releases it can verify. Earlier versions also listed Boxtron and SteamTinkerLaunch, whose releases publish no checksums, and "Proton-GE (tkg)", whose releases are Arch Linux Wine packages that Steam can't use. Copies you installed earlier keep working; to remove one, delete its folder from your launcher's tools folder (listed below).

Launcher	Where tools are installed
Steam	Steam's `compatibilitytools.d` folder, for example `~/.local/share/Steam/compatibilitytools.d` (created on the first install)
Heroic Games Launcher	`~/.config/heroic/tools/proton`

ProtoGNOME finds Steam in `~/.local/share/Steam`, `~/.steam/root`, `~/.steam/steam` and `~/.steam/debian-installation`, and also the **Flatpak** (`~/.var/app/com.valvesoftware.Steam/data/Steam`) and **Snap** (`~/snap/steam/common/.local/share/Steam`) versions. It uses the first one it finds, in that order.

GE-Proton works with Steam and Heroic; **Luxtorpeda works only with Steam**, so it can't be installed into Heroic. Lutris isn't offered: it runs Wine builds, and neither tool is one.

3 System requirements

Operating system	64-bit (amd64) Debian, Ubuntu, Pop!_OS or a derivative
Libraries	GTK 3, libsecret and SQLite (`libsqlite3-0`), installed with the package
Also needed	`tar` and `xz-utils` (normally already installed)
Network	Internet connection to reach GitHub
Disk space	Several hundred MB per Proton version

4 Installing ProtoGNOME

Each release includes `protognome_<version>_amd64.deb`, SHA-256 and SHA-512 checksums, a detached GPG signature and the Nordheim Online public key (`pubkey.asc`).

```
sha256sum -c protognome_<version>_amd64.deb.sha256
gpg --import pubkey.asc
gpg --verify protognome_<version>_amd64.deb.asc protognome_<version>_amd64.deb
sudo apt install ./protognome_<version>_amd64.deb
```

Open **ProtoGNOME** from your applications menu.

Building from source

```
# Requires Flutter 3.24+, cmake, ninja-build, libgtk-3-dev and g++
git clone https://github.com/TaliskerMan/ProtoGNOME.git
cd ProtoGNOME
flutter pub get
bash build_release.sh
```

Uninstalling

`sudo apt remove protognome`. Tools you installed stay in your launchers' folders; remove them in ProtoGNOME first if you don't want them.

5 Quick start

1. Open ProtoGNOME and choose **Tools** in the side rail.
2. Choose where to install (**Steam** or **Heroic**) from the launcher list.
3. Pick a tool, for example **GE-Proton**. ProtoGNOME lists its recent releases.
4. Click **Install** next to the release you want. When it finishes, it's marked **Installed**.
5. Restart Steam. In a game's **Properties → Compatibility**, choose the new tool.

6 Using ProtoGNOME

The side rail has four sections: **Tools**, **Games**, **Settings** and **About**. Banners at the top warn you if Steam wasn't found, or if Steam is running: Steam only reads its tool list at start-up, so restart it after installing or removing tools.

Tools

Control	What it does
Launcher list	Where to install: Steam or Heroic. A launcher that isn't installed is marked "(Not Installed)".
Tool chips	Switch between GE-Proton and Luxtorpeda
Release list	Recent releases, with date and download size
Install	Downloads, verifies and installs that release. Downloads over 10 MB use several parallel connections; the finished file is verified the same way. A release that can't be verified shows **Can't be verified** instead.
Remove	Deletes an installed release after you confirm
Refresh release list	Fetches the latest releases from GitHub

Games

Lists the games in your Steam libraries, with the compatibility tool each one uses. Type in **Search games…** to filter, or click **Refresh game list**. This view is read-only: change a game's tool in Steam itself.

Settings

Section	What it shows or does
Steam Installation	The detected Steam folder, compatibility-tools folder and config folder, and whether the installation looks valid
GitHub API Token	Optional personal access token to raise GitHub's rate limit (see below)
About ProtoGNOME	The installed version, license and author

About

Version, license, and credits to ProtonUp-Qt.

7 How installs are protected

Compatibility tools are programs that run your games, so ProtoGNOME is careful about what it installs:

- **Verification is required.** Before installing, ProtoGNOME checks the download against everything available for it: the checksum file its authors publish (`.sha512sum`, `.sha256sum`, `.sha512` or `.sha256`; GE-Proton and Luxtorpeda both publish one) and the SHA-256 digest GitHub records for every uploaded file. Every check must pass.
- **No checksum, no install.** A release with neither a checksum file nor a GitHub digest is marked **Can't be verified** and has no Install button.
- **The right build.** GE-Proton publishes x86_64 and aarch64 builds; ProtoGNOME picks the x86_64 build and checks it against that build's own checksum.
- **Safe extraction.** Archive contents are checked before extraction; any file that would land outside the install folder is refused.
- **No shell commands.** `tar` is run directly, with fixed arguments.
- **Private staging.** Downloads are unpacked in a private temporary folder, then cleaned up.
- **Size limit.** Downloads over 4 GB are refused.
- **Steam's files are read, never written.** ProtoGNOME reads Steam's `config.vdf` and `libraryfolders.vdf` to list games but doesn't change them.

8 GitHub token (optional)

GitHub limits how often an app can check releases without signing in (about 60 requests an hour). If you see a rate-limit message:

1. On GitHub, create a **personal access token** with no extra scopes (public read access is enough).
2. In ProtoGNOME, open **Settings → GitHub API Token**, paste it, and click **Save token**.

The token is stored in your desktop's keyring (libsecret), not in a plain file.

9 Privacy and files

ProtoGNOME contacts only GitHub (to list and download releases). It has no telemetry, and it uses your desktop's own font rather than downloading one.

Item	Location
Release cache and preferences	`~/.local/share/io.protognome.protognome/protognome.db`
Activity log	`~/.local/state/protognome/app.log`
GitHub token	Your desktop keyring

10 Troubleshooting

"GitHub API rate limit exceeded". Wait an hour, or add a GitHub token in Settings.

Steam isn't detected. ProtoGNOME looks in the native, Flatpak and Snap Steam folders listed above; the path can't be set by hand. Install Steam and run it once, then restart ProtoGNOME.

Install is missing for Luxtorpeda in Heroic. Luxtorpeda works only with Steam; choose Steam in the launcher list.

A new tool doesn't appear in Steam. Restart Steam completely (Steam → Exit, then reopen).

"could not be verified against its published checksum". The download was corrupted or altered, or the checksum couldn't be fetched. Try again later; don't install it another way.

A release shows "Can't be verified". Its authors published no checksum and GitHub has no digest for it, so ProtoGNOME won't install it.

"Failed to load dynamic library 'libsqlite3.so'" (versions up to 1.0.13). Fixed in 1.0.14: ProtoGNOME now loads the system SQLite library (`libsqlite3-0`). Update ProtoGNOME.

Something else went wrong. Check `~/.local/state/protognome/app.log`.

11 Support and license

Report problems on GitHub (github.com/TaliskerMan/ProtoGNOME) or email **chuck@nordheim.online**.

ProtoGNOME is a fork of ProtonUp-Qt, © 2021–2024 DavidoTek, licensed under the GNU GPL v3. The compatibility tools it installs are separate projects under their own licenses.

Website	nordheim.online
Source code	github.com/TaliskerMan/ProtoGNOME
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